Page Checks Explained — A Guide for Marketers

This guide explains, in plain language, what the **Is It Agent-Ready? for SitecoreAI** panel in Page Builder shows, every check it runs, and **why each one matters**. Use it as a cheat sheet during demos so you can confidently answer "what does this check, and why should I care?"

The big idea: four questions every page must answer

AI assistants (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Perplexity) and AI search now read your pages to answer people's questions. Before an AI agent can quote your page, four things have to be true:

Category	The question	In plain terms
Reach	Can AI agents get to it?	The page isn't hidden, blocked or pointing somewhere else
Read	Can they read it?	The page is laid out so a machine can find the real content
Understand	Do they understand it?	Clear headings, a good title and summary, and labels that say what the content is
Trust	Will they trust and cite it?	Original, current, well-written content from a named source

The panel and the dashboard use the **same four categories and the same scoring**. The difference is what they look at: the panel scores **the page as you're editing it**, and the dashboard scores **the published page**. So when you've made changes you haven't published yet, the two scores can differ, and the panel tells you so.

How scoring works (the 30-second version)

- Every page gets a score **out of 100**.
- Checks come in three kinds:

- **Essential** — the must-haves. Together they're worth **80 points**.

- **Recommended** — the things that make a good page great. Together they're worth **20 points**.

- **Bonus** — extra credit, up to **+5 points** (the score still tops out at 100).

- The points in each group are **shared equally** between the checks that apply to the page. Fixing an Essential check moves the score much more than fixing a Recommended one, and that's on purpose: it's where to start.
- **Partial credit counts.** A page that's halfway there gets half the points.
- **Checks that don't apply are skipped, never failed.** A page with no images isn't marked down for image descriptions, and a page with no FAQ isn't marked down for FAQ answers. They're listed as **N/A** under "Doesn't apply to this page".
- Some checks need a scan first (page speed, and the AI checks if they haven't run). Until they've run they show **Not checked** with a **Run** button, and don't count either way.
- The verdict is **Agent-ready at 80 or more**, **Almost there from 60 to 79**, and **Not ready below 60**. The dashboard uses the same thresholds.
- The panel doesn't show points, except on fixes: **"+N pts"** shows how much the score would go up if you fixed it.

What the panel shows

The header: the app name, a **Draft** or **Live** label (hover or focus it to see what was scored), and **Re-scan**.

Three tabs: Score, **Agent View** (the page as an AI agent receives it, below) and **AI Assist** (suggested fixes you can apply to the page, below).

The Score tab, top to bottom:

1. **The verdict:** a score ring out of 100, the verdict (Agent-ready, Almost there or Not ready), **▲ or ▼ N since last scan**, and one sentence, such as "2 fixes would make this page agent-ready."

2. **Four category bars:** Reach, Read, Understand and Trust, each scored out of 100. Click one to show only that category's checks; click it again to show them all.

3. **Site issues (only when there are any):** a red strip when something about the **whole site** keeps AI agents out of every page, such as a firewall that blocks ChatGPT, or a robots.txt that shuts out AI search. It's not part of this page's score, and it isn't something you fix in the page: **View in dashboard** opens the Agent access tab with the details and a note for your developer.

4. **Top fixes:** the three fixes worth the most, each with "+N pts", a **You can fix** or **Developer** badge, and a button:

- **Generate** opens AI Assist at that fix: the title and description, FAQ answers, question headings or image alt text.

- **Choose author** opens AI Assist's author byline (article pages).

- **Copy snippet** copies ready-to-paste code, such as structured data.

- **Send to developer** copies a note with the page address, what we found and the fix, to paste into a ticket or a message.

- **Show how** opens the check below with the details.

5. **All checks,** grouped by category, with a **Needs work / All** switch. Every check shows a status icon and word (✓ **Pass**, **! Improve**, ✕ **Fix**, **— N/A**, or **Not checked**), its outcome, and where the data came from (**Draft**, **Live**, **Fields**, **AI** or **PageSpeed**). Open one to see **why it matters**, **what we found**, and the fix. Code sits behind **Show code**.

On the home page, a **Site check** group at the bottom shows whether your organisation is described for AI. It isn't part of the page's score.

"Since last scan" compares with the score from the previous time the page was scanned (opening it, or Re-scan). Edits you make afterwards show against that, so you can watch a fix move the score.

The Agent View tab: what an AI agent receives

AI agents increasingly ask a website for a page **in Markdown**: plain text with simple marks for headings, lists and links, and none of the page's code. When a site answers with Markdown, the agent reads the whole page for a fraction of the effort. When it doesn't, the agent gets the full web page: menus, footer, scripts, styles and tracking, often 30 to 50 times more to read than the content itself.

The tab asks the published page for Markdown, the way an agent does, and shows:

1. **Four checks** (green when they pass):

- **Markdown response:** the page answers with Markdown.

- **HTML fallback:** people's browsers still get the normal page.

- **Vary: Accept:** a technical label that stops caches from handing a browser the Markdown, or an agent the web page.

- **Distinct versions:** the Markdown really is smaller than the web page. This one waits until Markdown is served.

2. **The saving:** how many "tokens" (the units AI reads in, about 4 characters each) the web page costs, against the Markdown. If your site doesn't serve Markdown yet, it shows the saving you'd get: **"If you served Markdown: about 97% fewer tokens"**.

3. **Compare**, with a **Before / After** switch. It opens on **Before** when your page doesn't serve Markdown (the problem), and on **After** when it does (the win).

- **Before**, "Without optimisation: the full web page an agent downloads today." A bar and a list show where the page's tokens go: **your content**, **scripts**, **styles**, **markup** (the page's code: tags, settings,

icons), **menus, header and footer**, and **structured data**. Each has its count and share, so the colours are never the only clue. Scripts, styles, markup and menus are red: an agent pays for them and throws them away. Structured data is grey, not red, because agents use it. One line sums it up, for example **"Your content is 2% of what an agent downloads. 96% (14,925 tokens) is code and layout."** Below it is the start of the page's actual code, with the red parts highlighted and your content left plain. On many sites your content doesn't appear until thousands of tokens in, and the tab says where it starts.

- **After**, "With optimisation: the same page as Markdown." This is the Markdown itself. If your site doesn't serve it yet, the app converts your draft so you can see what agents would get, labelled **"Preview: your site doesn't serve this yet"**. Below it, **What was removed** lists each red part struck through, with the tokens it saves, and the total (for example **"−14,998 tokens, about 97% fewer"**; without "about" once your site serves Markdown and the saving is measured).

4. **Why it matters**, under the switch in both views, using this page's own numbers:

- **It fits:** agents read within a fixed token budget, so a page that's mostly code can be cut short before they reach your content.

- **It's easier to quote:** with less noise, your answer is easier for an agent to find and cite correctly.

- **It's cheaper to read:** agents can read more of your site for the same cost.

5. **Is the Markdown complete?** Once your site serves Markdown: does it start with the page's title and meta description, does it include your content (headings, paragraphs, FAQ answers), and does it leave out the menus and footer?

6. **How to fix** (for your developer), with **Send to developer**: the options are under **Agents can get this page as Markdown**, below.

The score counts the four checks as one Essential check (**Agents can get this page as Markdown**) and the completeness as a Recommended one (**The Markdown version is complete**).

Your draft or the published page?

The panel reads the page **as it is in Page Builder right now**, including edits you haven't saved or published. Change a heading and the score updates by itself a moment later. There's no need to re-scan.

- **Content checks** (headings, paragraphs, images, links, FAQ answers, and the AI checks) read **your draft**.
- **Behind-the-scenes checks** (the title tag, canonical, metadata and structured data) read **the published page**, because they live in a part of the page the editor doesn't show. They catch up when you publish.

- Each check shows where it looked: a small **Draft** or **Live** label next to its name.
- When your draft's text differs from the published page, a note at the top says **"Scored from your draft. It differs from the live page"**, with how many blocks of text changed.
- The AI checks don't re-run on every edit. When you've changed the text since they ran, they say so and offer **Re-run**.
- If the editor can't share the draft, the panel falls back to the published page, as before, and the labels say **Live**.

🚦 The gate (runs first)

Is this page allowed to be found?

What it checks: Whether the page is deliberately hidden from search engines and AI — the "noindex" setting in Sitecore, or a "noindex" or "nosnippet" tag on the page.

Why it matters: If a page is set to "do not index," search won't list it and AI won't quote it, no matter how good the content is. Instead of a score, the panel tells you straight away, so you don't spend time on a page that's invisible by design (or so you catch a live page that was hidden by mistake).

🟢 Reach — Can AI agents get to it?

Canonical points to this page — Essential

What it checks: Whether the page has a "canonical tag" — a behind-the-scenes label that says "this is the official address of this page" — and that it points to this page.

Why it matters: The same content is often reachable at several addresses. Without a canonical tag, search engines and AI treat them as duplicates and split the credit between them, or cite the wrong one. (Usually set in the page template by a developer.)

🔵 Read — Can they read it?

Content is there without JavaScript — Essential, Page Builder panel only

What it checks: Whether the text on your page is in the page's HTML from the start, or only appears after code runs in the visitor's browser. The panel compares what the editor shows with what the server sends, and lists the components whose text only appears in the browser (for example, a "Related articles" list that loads after the page opens).

Why it matters: Most AI crawlers don't run that code. They read the HTML the server sends, so anything added later in the browser is invisible to them, however good it is. (A fix for your developer: render that content on the server.)

Good to know: messages like "No articles found" that a listing shows only in the editor aren't counted. New text you haven't published yet can also show up here until you publish. The dashboard can't see your draft, so it doesn't score this check.

Page structure is machine-readable — Recommended

What it checks: Whether the page uses the standard structural labels in its code (`main` , `article` , `nav` , `header`) that mark out the key regions, and whether buttons and icon links have a text label.

Why it matters: These labels are like room signs in a building: they help AI agents go straight to the real content and skip menus and footers.

Agents can get this page as Markdown — Essential

What it checks: We ask the published page for Markdown, as an AI agent does, and for the normal web page, as a browser does. Full marks need all four checks on the Agent View tab: Markdown comes back, browsers still get the web page, the "Vary: Accept" label is set, and the Markdown is smaller than the web page. Markdown without the other three gets half marks or more.

Why it matters: Markdown gives agents your content without the page's code, so they read more of it, faster, and are less likely to give up on a heavy page. On a typical Sitecore page the Markdown is over 90% smaller.

Good to know: this is a setting for the whole site, so your developer fixes it once for every page. Until then every page shows it as a fix. The options: **accept-md** for Next.js sites (`npx accept-md init` ; on Sitecore's Content SDK starter it needs three small changes by hand, which the fix card lists; the BrandX demo site serves Markdown this way), **Markdown for Agents** if the site is behind Cloudflare, or a route your developer writes. A page that isn't published yet shows **Not checked**.

The Markdown version is complete — Recommended, once Markdown is served

What it checks: In the Markdown your site serves: the title and description at the top match the page's **Title** and **Meta description** fields; at least 90% of the page's headings, paragraphs and FAQ answers are included; and menus, header and footer make up less than a quarter of it.

Why it matters: An agent answers from the Markdown alone. If it leaves out the FAQ answers, or is mostly menu links, the agent misses what the page is for. An empty Meta description field is something you can fix in Page Builder.

Good to know: until the site serves Markdown this shows **N/A**, so it doesn't count either way.

Page loads fast — Recommended, runs when you ask

What it checks: Google's PageSpeed score for the page. Click **Run scan** on the row to check it.

Why it matters: Slow pages frustrate visitors, rank lower, and can time out when an AI assistant fetches them on someone's behalf.

Understand — Do they understand it?

One clear H1 and logical headings — Essential

What it checks: That the page has exactly **one main headline (H1)** and that sub-headings step down in order (H1 → H2 → H3) without skipping levels.

Why it matters: Headings are the page's table of contents. AI uses them to work out what the page is about and where each answer starts.

Title and description are set — Essential

What it checks: The page title (ideally **50–60 characters**) and the meta description (ideally **120–160 characters**). It reads the Sitecore fields you edit.

Why it matters: These are the summary that search results and AI show before anyone clicks. If the description is missing, search engines write their own, usually a random snippet you don't control. AI Assist can write both for you, and the dashboard can write the missing descriptions for many pages at once.

Structured data is present and valid — Essential

What it checks: Whether the page has the "schema" labels (hidden code called JSON-LD) that it needs, and that they're complete:

- **Breadcrumbs** on every page except the home page (where the page sits in the site).
- **FAQ** labels when the page has questions and answers.
- **Article** labels on article pages.

If something is missing, the check gives you **the code to paste in**.

Why it matters: Schema tells AI exactly what the content is — an article, a set of answers, a page in a section — without guessing. **This used to always pass, even when the labels weren't there. It now looks at the real page**, so it tells you what's actually missing. AI Assist shows the same code; your developer adds it to the page template (or AI Assist saves it, if your templates have a field for it).

Page identity metadata is complete — Recommended

What it checks: The page's language setting and its social sharing tags (type, title, description and image).

Why it matters: These tell AI what the page is and in which language, and they decide whether a shared link shows a rich preview card or a bare address.

FAQ answers are quotable — Recommended

What it checks: That each FAQ answer is **40–300 characters** — long enough to be useful, short enough to quote. It finds questions and answers in **any** accordion or expandable section, not just one component.

Why it matters: AI assistants lift FAQ answers word for word. A one-line answer is useless; a wall of text won't fit. AI Assist can rewrite the answers that miss the range and save them to the FAQ items.

Sections answer real questions — Recommended

What it checks: Whether some section headings are phrased as the questions people ask ("How do I…?", "What is…?").

Why it matters: People ask AI questions. A section headed by the question it answers is easy to match and cite. Only rephrase where it's natural. AI Assist suggests question headings for you to copy into the page.

Easy to read and quote — Recommended

What it checks: How easy the writing is to read, paragraph by paragraph (aiming for an early-college reading level or simpler), and whether paragraphs are a comfortable length (about 40–120 words).

Why it matters: Clear, well-sized paragraphs are what AI quotes accurately. Dense text gets paraphrased badly or skipped.

Images are described — Recommended

What it checks: What share of images have alt text — a short written description.

Why it matters: AI can't see pictures; the alt text is how it learns what an image shows. It's also what screen readers announce. AI Assist looks at each image and suggests alt text, and flags alt text that is just a file name (such as "campaign-creators-unsplash"), which this check counts as present.

🟤 Trust — Will they trust and cite it?

Content is original, not generic — Recommended

What it checks: Our AI reads the page's main text and judges whether it's genuinely **original and valuable**, or generic content that could have come from anywhere. The answer is remembered until the text changes, so revisiting an unchanged page shows the same rating straight away.

Why it matters: AI assistants cite the source that adds something. Content that repeats what's everywhere else is rarely chosen.

Author is named and linked — Recommended, article pages only

What it checks: Whether the article names its author and links to an author profile.

Why it matters: A named author with a profile lets AI judge expertise before citing an article. AI Assist lets you pick the author from the people who already write for the site. It reads the published page, so the score changes after you publish.

Content is recently updated — Recommended

What it checks: When the page was last updated: full marks within six months, partial up to two years.

Why it matters: AI favours current sources, especially on fast-moving topics.

Enough depth to be cited — Recommended

What it checks: How much body text the page has (full marks at about 800 words).

Why it matters: Thin pages rarely hold a complete answer, so AI looks elsewhere.

Links say where they go — Recommended

What it checks: Whether links use descriptive text ("view our pricing plans") instead of vague phrases ("click here", "read more"). Links like "Download the 2026 report" count as descriptive.

Why it matters: The link text tells AI what the linked page is about before it follows it.

Answers the next question too — Bonus

What it checks: Our AI suggests the questions a reader would likely ask next, and checks whether the page answers them.

Why it matters: AI prefers sources that also cover the obvious follow-up. Add content only where it genuinely helps readers.

🏢 Site check on the home page: your organisation

Your organisation is described for AI

What it checks: Whether the home page has **Organization schema**: your company's name, website, logo, social profiles, description and contact details, in machine-readable form.

This is a **site check**: it's about the whole site, so it isn't part of any page's score. The panel shows it when the **home page** is open, and the dashboard shows it on the **Agent access** tab.

What the home page has	What you see
Complete organisation details	Pass
Some details missing	A warning listing them, and corrected code to paste in
No organisation details at all	A warning, "Not added yet", and ready-to-paste code
The home page couldn't be checked	"Couldn't check" — it doesn't count

Why it matters: This is how AI and search engines know who runs the site, so they name and cite your brand correctly (and it feeds Google's knowledge panel). **This also used to always pass.** The BrandX

demo site has none, and the check now says so.

Quick reference: the scorecard

Category	Check	Kind
Reach	Canonical points to this page	Essential
Read	Content is there without JavaScript	Essential (Page Builder panel only)
Read	Page structure is machine-readable	Recommended
Read	Agents can get this page as Markdown	Essential
Read	The Markdown version is complete	Recommended (once Markdown is served)
Read	Page loads fast	Recommended
Understand	One clear H1 and logical headings	Essential
Understand	Title and description are set	Essential
Understand	Structured data is present and valid	Essential
Understand	Page identity metadata is complete	Recommended
Understand	FAQ answers are quotable	Recommended
Understand	Sections answer real questions	Recommended
Understand	Easy to read and quote	Recommended
Understand	Images are described	Recommended
Trust	Content is original, not generic	Recommended
Trust	Author is named and linked	Recommended (articles)
Trust	Content is recently updated	Recommended
Trust	Enough depth to be cited	Recommended
Trust	Links say where they go	Recommended
Trust	Answers the next question too	Bonus
Site	Your organisation is described for AI	Site check (own score)

The dashboard's **Agent access** tab has the other site checks: whether AI agents get past your firewall, robots.txt, Markdown, the sitemap, llms.txt, your about, contact and privacy pages, real 404s, and the

Bonus protocol checks. The panel only flags the ones that keep agents out of every page (the red strip above). Markdown is checked on each page too, as **Agents can get this page as Markdown**, and shown on the Agent View tab.

AI Assist: suggested fixes you can apply

The **AI Assist** tab collects the fixes the panel can make for you, ordered by the points they'd add. **Generate** (or **Choose author**) on a fix in the Score tab opens the tab at that fix. Each suggestion shows **what's there now** and the suggestion, which you can edit before you use it.

Fix	What it does	Where it goes
Title, description and social	Writes the meta title, meta description and the two social sharing (Open Graph) fields	**Apply to field** saves it to the page's field
Quotable FAQ answers	Rewrites FAQ answers so each one answers the question in its first sentence and stands alone, in 40–300 characters	**Apply to field** saves it to that FAQ item
Image alt text	Looks at each image and suggests alt text. Images with no alt text, or alt text that is just a file name, come first	**Apply to field** saves it on the image field, so it changes this use of the image only, not the image in the media library
Author byline (article pages)	Lists the people who already write for the site, or lets you type a name. No AI	**Apply** saves it to the page's author field
Structured data	The schema code the page is missing, built from the page itself. No AI	Copy it for your developer; **Apply** appears only if your templates have a field for it
Question headings	Suggests headings phrased as the questions each section answers	Copy, then change the heading in Page Builder
Summary paragraph	A 40–70 word paragraph that answers the page's main question, to place at the top	Copy, then paste it into the page's intro

How a change is saved:

- **Nothing is written until you confirm. Apply** opens a box showing the field, the item and its language, and the value **before** → **after**. Only **Write to Sitecore** saves it.
- Changes go into the **current version** of the page or item and follow your workflow. **Nothing is published**: the live site changes when you publish as usual.

- After saving, a message confirms it, and the app keeps a record of the change (in the browser's console) with the old and the new value, so it can be undone by hand.
- If a component is **shared** (used on other pages too), the confirmation says so: the change shows everywhere that component is used.
- When **Apply** can't be used, the reason is shown next to it, for example "This page's template has no "MetaDescription" field." Copy still works.

What the suggestions are based on:

- **Your draft:** the page's main text, unpublished edits included. The buttons wait until the page text has been read.
- **Your brand voice document:** tone, words to use and avoid, and compliance rules such as "no guaranteed returns". If no brand voice has been set up, neutral, plain-language guidelines are used.
- **Length limits** are shown under each suggestion (60 characters for the meta title, 120–160 for the meta description, 40–300 for FAQ answers, 125 for alt text). The count turns amber when a suggestion is outside the range, so you can trim it first.
- Asking again for the same page text costs nothing: the answer is remembered until the text changes.

In demo mode (`?demo=1`), every fix shows an example suggestion, and nothing is sent to the AI. **Apply** opens the same confirmation box, but **Write to Sitecore** only says "Demo: nothing was written to Sitecore."

Demo talking points (the big picture)

For the full 5-minute walk-through with demo data, see **SYMPOSIUM-DEMO-SCRIPT**.

- **"Four plain questions."** Can AI agents get to it, read it, understand it, and trust it? Every check answers one of them.
- **"Answer first."** One verdict and one sentence: what it would take to make this page agent-ready.
- **"Fix the essentials first."** Top fixes ranks them by what they're worth, and every fix has a button: Generate, Copy snippet or Send to developer.
- **"Fix it right here."** AI Assist writes the description, FAQ answers and alt text, and saves them to the page after you confirm. Nothing is published until you say so.
- **"It checks the real page."** Schema checks look at what's actually on the page, and hand you the code when something's missing.
- **"Fair by design."** Checks that don't apply are skipped, not failed.
- **"Score as you write."** Edit a heading and the score updates by itself, before you publish.

- **"It sees what AI crawlers see."** The panel spots content that only appears after JavaScript runs, which most AI crawlers never see.
- **"One set of rules everywhere."** The panel and the dashboard score with the same rules. The panel scores your draft, the dashboard the published page.
- **"A perfect page can still be invisible."** If the firewall blocks ChatGPT, no page edit helps; the red strip says so and points to the dashboard.
- **"See what the agent gets."** The Agent View shows the page as Markdown, and the saving: on the BrandX demo site, which now serves Markdown, the home page is about 1,500 tokens instead of 54,000.
- **"Red is what an agent pays for and throws away." Before** marks the code in the page an agent downloads; **After** shows what Markdown removes. On the BrandX demo site's home page, under 1% of the HTML is the content itself.